

Output Content (OC)

Score: 1/5 — Serious concern | Confidence: high

Benchmark: ASAP++ | Context: Qatari and Arab High School Arabic Essay Writers (Grades 10–12)

Output Content definition: Whether ground-truth labels align with the judgments of regional stakeholders.

Each section below is followed by an evidence table. Three types of evidence are cited: **[QN]** — verbatim quotes extracted from the benchmark paper; **[WEB-N]** — web sources consulted during assessment; **[DN]** / **[DATASET-DN]** — sampled datapoints from the benchmark dataset, with an interpretation note.

Justification

Ground-truth labels were produced by three India-based annotators with English MA-level training, English newspaper editorial experience, and high English exam/TOEFL scores [Q27, Q28, Q29, Q30, Q53], scoring single-pass [Q22, Q40] with anchoring to the original US ASAP raters' overall scores [Q23, Q25]. None of these qualifications confer expertise in Arabic writing assessment or Qatari/Arab curriculum norms. The anchoring mechanism [Q25, Q26] further embeds US rater judgments as the normative standard. Per the elicitation, OC was flagged HIGH priority because Qatar/Arab teachers may apply different MSA convention, organization, and style standards. Convergent validity with the deployment's regional stakeholders is essentially zero.

ID	Evidence
Q22	"Unlike the ASAP AEG dataset in which every essay was annotated by 2 annotators, we use only 1 annotator here for each essay." (p.3)
Q23	"For the ground truth, we make use of the overall score of the essays given by the original annotators of the ASAP AEG dataset." (p.3)
Q25	"The final score that is chosen is the one from the annotator that is closest to the overall scores." (p.3)
Q26	"One of the reasons that we do this is because, in the 2 prompts that were rated by the original raters, there is a very high Pearson correlation (nearly 0.9) between the overall scores and the individual attribute scores." (p.3)
Q27	"We made use of a total of three annotators to annotate the essays." (p.3)
Q28	"Each of the annotators had competence in English, either by scoring quite high marks in their high school exams (over 90% in English), or scoring over 110 in ToEFL." (p.3)
Q29	"Each of them also had some experience in evaluating texts, such as interning at The Hindu (a top English newspaper in India), being the chief editor of the college magazine, etc." (p.3)
Q30	"All the annotators have either studied or are studying English at a Master of Arts (MA) level." (p.3)
Q40	"Most of the essays required only a single annotator. Only about a sixth of the essays required a second annotator." (p.4)
Q53	"We thank the annotators of our task - Advait Jayakumar, Janice Pereira and Elaine Mathias - for their help in creating this resource." (p.5)

Strengths

- The QC mechanism — second annotator triggered when any attribute differs by 2+ points from either original rater [Q24] — is methodologically sound as a template that could be re-applied with Arabic-curriculum annotators.
- Annotator credentials and roles are at least partially documented [Q27–Q30, Q53], enabling explicit comparison with required regional expertise.

ID	Evidence
Q24	"In case the scoring of a particular attribute for a particular prompt differs from either of the original scorers by 2 or more points, the essay is then annotated by another annotator." (p.3)
Q27	"We made use of a total of three annotators to annotate the essays." (p.3)
Q28	"Each of the annotators had competence in English, either by scoring quite high marks in their high school exams (over 90% in English), or scoring over 110 in ToEFL." (p.3)

Q29	"Each of them also had some experience in evaluating texts, such as interning at The Hindu (a top English newspaper in India), being the chief editor of the college magazine, etc." (p.3)
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Checklist

Checklist item definitions:

ID	Assessment Question
OC-1	Do ground-truth labels reflect regional stakeholder perspectives?
OC-2	Assess potential annotator-regional population disagreement
OC-3	Review annotator demographics from documentation
OC-4	Consider label re-annotation by regional annotators
OC-5	Review aggregation methods for minority perspective erasure
OC-6	Document label issues harming convergent/external validity

Checklist responses:

OC-1: No — labels reflect Indian English-MA annotators anchoring to US ASAP raters [Q23, Q25, Q30]. There is no Qatari/Arab curriculum stakeholder representation.

OC-2: Disagreement with the regional population is expected to be very high: zero overlap in language, curriculum, or rubric tradition. The closest Arab-anchored rubric (LAILA seven-trait, [WEB-12]) was developed by separate teams and uses different trait definitions.

OC-3: Annotator demographics are partially documented [Q27, Q28, Q29, Q30, Q53]: three named individuals, all India-based, all with MA-level English study, all with English-language editorial experience or high TOEFL/English exam scores. No Datasheet or Data Statement is referenced.

OC-4: Re-annotation by representative Qatari/Arab teachers is required and is the only route to label validity for this deployment. QAES/QCAW's Qatari-context annotation work [WEB-3] and LAILA's Arabic high school annotation [WEB-12] are precedents.

OC-5: Aggregation anchors to the original US holistic score [Q25] — a strong erasure mechanism for any non-US perspective. The 0.9 Pearson correlation justification [Q26] is circular: it merely shows the original US raters' holistic and trait scores agree with each other.

OC-6: Label issues are categorical: ground truth encodes US-rater judgments mediated by Indian English annotators, with no path to Arab curriculum norms. This violates both convergent and external validity for the deployment.

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WEB-3	QAES annotated Qatari argumentative writing with trait-specific conventions appropriate to Qatari context (https://www.mdpi.com/2306-5729/10/9/148)
WEB-12	LAILA used annotators trained on Arab high school writing — example of appropriate annotator profile for this deployment (https://arxiv.org/abs/2512.24235)

Information Gaps

- No information on Arabic-language competence of any benchmark annotator (none is claimed); paper does not mention Arabic at all.

Requires Expert Verification

- Whether Qatari teacher rubric judgments converge or diverge meaningfully from other Arab curriculum bodies (per elicitation Q2/A2).

Remediation

Gap 1: Ground truth produced by India-based English-MA annotators anchored to US ASAP raters; no Arab curriculum stakeholder representation.

Recommendation: Re-annotate any Arabic AES dataset used for this deployment with Qatar MOEHE-trained Arabic teachers, using a multi-rater protocol with explicit disagreement resolution; document annotator demographics and curriculum training in a Datasheet/Data Statement.